
PAPERBOY

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

The 10-year Treasury closed at a 19-year high and prediction markets now put an October Fed hike at 69% — which is what actually moved chip stocks from Taipei to New York.

AI

Anthropic ships Sonnet 5.5 and holds the price

WHAT HAPPENED

Anthropic released [Claude Sonnet 5.5](#) on Monday, keeping list pricing at \$2 per million input tokens and \$10 per million output — identical to Sonnet 5 — while claiming output generation is "30%+ faster" and that the model "costs up to 30% less for most work" through token efficiency rather than a price cut. The model id is claude-sonnet-5-5, with a 1M-token context window, 128K maximum output, a June 2026 knowledge cutoff and five thinking-effort levels from low to max, high by default. Anthropic's own comparison table puts it at 70.6% on Terminal-Bench 4.0 against Sonnet 5's 10.3%, and 55.5% on CursorBench against 34.1%. FrontierCode 1.1 is 46.2% at default effort and 52.1% only at the "xhigh" setting. It ships on the Claude Platform, AWS Bedrock, Google Vertex and Azure.

WHAT IT MEANS

The pricing is the story. Frontier labs have spent two years cutting sticker prices to stay level with each other; Anthropic held the sticker and moved the cost down inside the model, which is harder and protects margin. The Terminal-Bench jump is large enough to invite suspicion, but it is Anthropic's published figure, not an outlet's inference.

WATCH NEXT

Whether OpenAI and Google answer on price or on capability — and whether OpenAI's tool-use pause gets a resumption date.

AI chief executives lunch at the White House today

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump and House Speaker Mike Johnson host tech leaders for lunch today on AI companies' responsibility for safety and the government's role in regulating it.

[Reported attendees](#) include Mark Zuckerberg, Dario Amodei, Sundar Pichai, Jensen Huang, Palantir's Alex Karp and OpenAI's Greg Brockman, though rosters ahead of these meetings have a history of shifting. Johnson set the tone on Fox Business on Monday, casting AI risk warnings as a Democratic election tactic: "[Don't buy it. It is a Chinese psyop. I really believe that. It's not a conspiracy theory.](#)" Trump's own Truth Social post calling AI danger "a HOAX" is being widely attached to this meeting; he wrote it on 14 September.

WHAT IT MEANS

A fortnight ago the administration was in court against Anthropic over a Pentagon contract. Sunday it had Amodei to dinner. Today it seats him beside a Speaker who thinks his risk case is Chinese information warfare. The subject nobody will name is federal preemption of state AI rules — the one thing the labs want, and the one thing that would strip states of the per-violation enforcement leverage they have just discovered.

WATCH NEXT

Any readout mentioning preemption or federal procurement; the still-vacant CAISI directorship. The lunch falls after this brief.

Nvidia adds \$150bn to the buyback, the largest increase on record

WHAT HAPPENED

Nvidia's board authorised a [\\$150 billion increase](#) to its share repurchase programme on Monday, taking the total remaining authorisation to \$235 billion, executable through fiscal 2028. The company calls it "the largest share repurchase authorization increase in history"; Apple's \$110bn in May 2024 was the previous record. Jensen Huang: "NVIDIA's growth is being driven by a once-in-a-generation platform shift to AI and accelerated computing. Our cash generation gives us the capacity to invest in the technologies that advance this transformation and return capital to shareholders." The release does not disclose how much has been repurchased to date. Shares closed up 2.6% at \$231.01, one of few large-cap gainers on a down day.

WHAT IT MEANS

A buyback this size says Nvidia expects to generate more cash than it can usefully spend on itself — which sits oddly beside a year of reporting on capacity constraints and a \$1.2tn industry capex figure for 2027. Read it as confidence in the cash flow, not a signal about demand. It also puts a floor under a stock doing a great deal of index work.

WATCH NEXT

Micron's FQ4 and FY2026 results on Wednesday, guided to \$50.0bn plus or minus \$1.0bn — the first hard revenue number out of memory since Monday's selloff.

Taipei reopens and prices everything off Treasury yields

WHAT HAPPENED

Taiwan's exchange traded for the first time this week after Monday's Teachers' Day holiday. The **TAIEX closed at 47,631.96**, down 392.64 points or 0.82%, on turnover of NT\$785.04bn. TSMC closed exactly unchanged at NT\$2,475.00 and Hon Hai unchanged at NT\$250.50 — but MediaTek fell 7.10% to NT\$4,910.00, Alchip 3.25% and ASE 1.72%. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index had fallen 1.61% overnight. Memory partly steadied after Monday's rout, with Samsung up 0.93%, Kioxia up 0.56% and SK Hynix roughly flat at −0.17%; the Nikkei closed down 0.60% and the KOSPI down 0.27%.

WHAT IT MEANS

No chip-specific news moved any of this. A Taipei analyst put October Fed hike odds "at around 70 percent" and that is what the tape traded. MediaTek's 7% is the exception large enough to want an explanation, and no dated source offers a company-specific one — it is described as the sector's primary drag, which is a description, not a cause.

WATCH NEXT

TSMC's September revenue around 10 October; ASML's Q3 on 15 October.

Bonds are running the market, and the next Fed move is priced as a hike

WHAT HAPPENED

The 10-year Treasury [closed Monday at 5.24%](#), its highest since June 2007, and traded at 5.247% on Tuesday morning. Prediction-market pricing on Tuesday put the odds of an increase at the [27-28 October FOMC](#) at 69%, against 30% for a hold and about 2% for a cut; December sits at 76%. The Fed already raised 25 basis points (a quarter of a percentage point) on 16 September, to 3.75–4.00%, unanimously. US equities closed lower Monday: the Dow -0.67% to 51,481.51, the S&P 500 -0.77% to 7,683.69, the Nasdaq Composite -0.92% to 26,820.38. One correction worth carrying: crude did not jump 4%. WTI touched \$96.54 intraday on conflicting reports about US-Iran talks and settled near \$92.60, barely changed; Brent settled around \$105.28. Several outlets printed the intraday peak as the day's move.

WHAT IT MEANS

A central bank tightening into a bond market already at a 19-year high on the long end is the single fact explaining most other prices right now, semiconductors included. This is not an AI story wearing a macro costume; it is the reverse.

WATCH NEXT

August PCE on Wednesday at 08:30 ET; September CPI around 13 October. The first Fed speaker to call December live.

Meta poaches MongoDB's chief executive and takes 18% off the stock

WHAT HAPPENED

[MongoDB announced on Monday](#) that president and chief executive Chirantan "CJ" Desai was leaving immediately for a senior role at Meta. Dev Ittycheria, who ran the company from 2014 to 2025, returns as interim chief executive, and the board reaffirmed the guidance issued on 1 September. Chairman Tom Killalea: "MongoDB's business is strong, and there is no better person to take on the role of President and CEO in the interim than Dev Ittycheria." Meta announced separately the same day that Desai becomes Chief Enterprise Platform Officer, reporting directly to Mark Zuckerberg, running a new Meta Enterprise Platform that takes the company's models, agents and coding tools to corporate customers. MongoDB closed at \$334.68, down 18.46%. Intraday figures of 20%, 23% and 26% circulated; the close is the number.

WHAT IT MEANS

Meta has spent a year buying AI talent by the person. This is the first time it has bought a sitting public-company chief executive in order to open a business line it does not have — enterprise software, which Meta has never sold. Losing a CEO with no successor named earns a double-digit derating; whether it earns 18% is a separate question.

WATCH NEXT

MongoDB's Q3 results and whether the reaffirmed guidance holds; who else Meta names to the enterprise team.

SiMa.ai raises \$150m at \$1.45bn to sell chips that keep AI off the cloud

WHAT HAPPENED

Edge-AI chip company SiMa.ai [closed a \\$150 million Series C](#) on Monday at a \$1.45 billion valuation, co-led by Fidelity Management & Research and Amplify, with Alter Venture Partners, Dell Technologies Capital and StepStone participating. Total raised is now over \$500 million. Founder and chief executive Krishna Rangasayee, formerly chief operating officer at Groq, sells chips and software that let robots, drones and cameras run models on the device instead of sending them to a data centre, pitched on latency and as a cheaper alternative to Nvidia GPUs in humanoid robotics, automotive and drones.

WHAT IT MEANS

"Physical AI" is where venture money goes now that model training is a capital expense only five companies can carry. The bet is that inference at the edge becomes a separate silicon market with separate economics — one where Nvidia's advantage in training clusters does not transfer.

WATCH NEXT

A publicly named design win at an automotive or robotics OEM. CoreWeave's Fully Connected conference runs through 1 October.

Samsung puts \$1bn into Helix, the KKR-Nvidia infrastructure vehicle

WHAT HAPPENED

Samsung is [investing \\$1 billion](#) in Helix Digital Infrastructure, the AI-infrastructure company launched with more than \$10 billion committed by KKR, the Kuwait Investment Authority, Nvidia and Vistra, and run by former AWS chief executive Adam Selipsky. The money splits \$500 million from Samsung Electronics and \$500 million from five affiliates — Samsung C&T, Samsung SDS, Samsung SDI, Samsung Life Insurance and Samsung Fire & Marine. Helix targets hyperscale data centres, power generation and transmission, and fibre. Selipsky called the commitment "a strong vote of confidence in Helix's strategy". Samsung describes the move as going from "a traditional hardware component supplier to an active architect of the global AI infrastructure ecosystem", and names power availability as the binding constraint.

WHAT IT MEANS

A memory maker taking an equity position in the electricity and buildings its own customers need is vertical integration running in an unusual direction. Neither release gives megawatts, sites or a pipeline — which is exactly the number that would make this assessable.

WATCH NEXT

Helix's first disclosed site or power purchase agreement.

Senate passes the college-sports NIL bill 77-22

WHAT HAPPENED

The Senate passed S. 4668, the name-image-and-likeness bill for college athletes, at 9:42 PM Monday by [77 to 22](#) with one senator not voting — 63 Republicans, 13 Democrats and one independent in favour, 20 Democrats and two Republicans against. Earlier the same day the chamber agreed a Baldwin amendment on the bill's relationship to existing law 96-1, and rejected four others: a Booker amendment on post-eligibility insurance and catastrophic-injury funding failed 49-50, one on varsity coaching standards 47-52, a Kennedy amendment capping ticket-price increases 42-54, and a Paul amendment 1-94. The White House issued a statement the same day headed "President Trump Calls on Congress to Save College Sports". Note the coincidence: the motion to proceed on 17 September also carried 77-22 with one not voting. This is final passage.

WHAT IT MEANS

A 77-vote bipartisan majority on anything is itself the news. The bill federalises a patchwork of state NIL laws and the court settlements that replaced the NCAA's amateurism rules. The two-vote margins on the injury-funding amendments are where the real fight was, and the side that lost them was arguing that athletes carry the medical risk.

WATCH NEXT

The House, which has not scheduled it.

Trump announces a \$15bn steel plant in Iowa, five weeks before the midterms

WHAT HAPPENED

At a White House event Monday, Trump announced a roughly [\\$15 billion integrated steel plant](#) in Lee County, Iowa, to be built by Mesabi Metallics — owned by India's Essar Group — fed by iron ore from the company's Minnesota mine. The administration and company put it at 1,750 permanent jobs at \$49 an hour, 6,000 construction jobs, and 7.5 million tons a year in phase one, with first steel in 2030 at the earliest. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said "this deal is done"; the Iowa incentive package is not — it requires a special legislative session Governor Kim Reynolds has not called. Further figures carried only by Fox — \$18bn including the mine, 10 million tons at full capacity, \$95bn in economic activity — are not corroborated elsewhere.

WHAT IT MEANS

Every number here is a projection by the two parties with an interest in the number being large, about a facility that produces nothing for four years. What is checkable is the map: Iowa and Minnesota, five weeks before the midterms.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Reynolds calls the special session. Midterms 3 November; funding expires 11 December.

Brussels sanctions Russia twice and names its first five joint defence projects

WHAT HAPPENED

The EU Council on Monday listed [10 individuals and 17 entities](#) over the deportation of Ukrainian children, among them Rustam Minnikhanov, president of Tatarstan, and a children's camp in North Korea. The Council cites an estimate of "over 20 500 Ukrainian children" deported since the invasion began. A second package listed 10 judges and prosecutors over the barring of Yabloko — "the only political party that openly opposed Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine", the Council says — from September's Duma elections, noting Lev Shlosberg's sentence of "11 years and one month". Separately the Council approved the first five [European Defence Projects of Common Interest](#), covering drones, maritime and seabed, space, air and missile defence, and an Eastern Flank Watch. No funding figures were given.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two legible sanctions packages and five project names with no euros attached. Brussels keeps producing the instrument rather than the money: the €6.6bn Peace Facility tranche is neither confirmed nor denied three briefs running, and the reparations loan stays blocked by Belgium.

WATCH NEXT

The JHA Council on 1-2 October; any euro figure attached to the five projects.

France's civil servants strike as the pay freeze goes into a third year

WHAT HAPPENED

Eight unions, CGT and Force Ouvrière through CFDT, UNSA, FSU, Solidaires, CFE-CGC and FA-FP, called [Tuesday's public-sector day of action](#). They want the point d'indice, the multiplier that sets civil-service pay, unfrozen at least in line with inflation, and the sick-leave waiting day scrapped. Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu has confirmed the index point stays frozen for a third consecutive year, worth about €2 billion in savings, in a 2027 budget due to be tabled Wednesday. SNUipp-FSU, the largest primary-school union, forecast 40% of first-degree teachers would strike — a union projection, not a ministry count; no official turnout had been published as this brief went out. Force Ouvrière's Frédéric Souillot: "À chaque crise, on applaudit les fonctionnaires, qui sont traités comme des tabliers Excel le reste de l'année."

WHAT IT MEANS

Lecornu is taking the strike before the budget rather than after, which is a choice. The €2bn is small against the deficit and large against the politics — a government without a majority spending its first confrontation on the cheapest target available.

WATCH NEXT

Interior Ministry turnout figures; the PLF 2027 on Wednesday; Senate groups fixed 5 October.

Settlers riot in Jalud to stop a court-ordered return

WHAT HAPPENED

More than 100 settlers rioted overnight in [Jalud, near Nablus](#) in the occupied West Bank, to stop the Tubasi family returning to the home they were forced out of in July, a return the High Court ordered this month. Rioters blocked roads with burning tyres, threw stones at security forces and set fire to Palestinian homes and vehicles; Mahmoud Tubasi said his house burned to the ground. Three Border Police officers were lightly injured and three people arrested. The IDF said "due to the violence, the mission to return the family to their home was not completed" — its own account of its own operation. President Isaac Herzog called the violence "a moral stain" and "an attack on the rule of law and our most basic values"; Netanyahu blamed a "small number" of rioters.

WHAT IT MEANS

A High Court order was defeated on the ground by a crowd, and the state's own account is that it could not carry the order out. Four weeks before an election in which the blocs are level, the condemnations run well ahead of the arrests.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the return is attempted again; the Israeli election on 27 October.

SOURCES

[Anthropic — Claude Sonnet 5.5](#)

[Claude Platform docs — model overview and pricing](#)

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[Mediaite — Johnson calls AI doomsday warnings a 'Chinese psyop'](#)

[NVIDIA — \\$150 billion share repurchase authorization increase](#)

[Focus Taiwan — Taix ends down on higher US Treasury yields, crude prices](#)

[TradingEconomics — Taiwan stock market](#)

[US Treasury — daily yield curve, September 2026](#)

[Federal Reserve — FOMC calendar](#)

[Federal Reserve — FOMC statement, 16 September 2026](#)

[TheStreet — stock market close, 28 September 2026](#)

[MongoDB — CEO transition](#)

[TechCrunch — SiMa.ai hits \\$1.45B valuation](#)

[KKR — Samsung commits \\$1 billion to Helix Digital Infrastructure](#)

[Samsung Newsroom — \\$1 billion investment in Helix](#)

[US Senate — roll call vote 250, S. 4668 on passage](#)

[US Senate — roll call vote menu, 119th Congress 2nd session](#)

[Fox News — Trump unveils \\$15bn Iowa steel investment](#)

[Council of the EU — sanctions over deportation of Ukrainian children](#)

[Council of the EU — listings over the barring of Yabloko](#)

[Council of the EU — first five defence projects of common interest](#)

[LCP — Grève du 29 septembre: pourquoi les fonctionnaires réclament une hausse des salaires](#)

[Times of Israel — liveblog, 29 September 2026](#)